

SICA'26 AWARD NOMINATION RULES REGULATION

Social Impact Conference & Awards 2026 | TheCSRUniverse

Edition 6th | Venue: New Delhi | Date: September 2026 (3rd Week)

Important Note: ZERO Nomination Fee Policy

*"As a matter of internal policy, we have taken a conscious decision to NOT take any nomination fees for the award entries to make it more accessible. This step is aligned with our vision of being **Conscious, Social, & Responsible** (CSR). Our effort is to democratise the award process and bring opportunities for everyone to present their impactful work before our esteemed jury. With this decision, we also want to bring recognition to those who remain unrecognised despite their valuable contribution towards Social Impact and sustainability",
Ms Ruchika Kumar, Editor and Mr Ashish Jha, Founder, TheCSRUniverse*

PART A – WHO CAN APPLY

A1. Eligible Applicants

- Projects/initiatives launched, funded, or implemented by any institution, company, CSR arm, funding organisation, not-for-profit institution, NGO, or community service provider
- Philanthropists and individuals serving in their own capacity may nominate their initiative
- Foreign companies and MNCs with ongoing or concluded CSR projects in India are eligible to nominate
- The applicant must be an individual, a registered company, a CSR foundation/trust, or an implementing partner for a CSR project

A2. Eligible Projects & Initiatives

- The entry must be for a social project launched, executed (partially or fully), or active during the period of April 1, 2024, to March 31, 2026
- Projects launched on or after April 1, 2026, are not eligible for nomination in this edition
- The nominated project must have a defined start date, a stated target, and a documented current status
- The project must have provided services, support, or direct community benefit to people in their locality or anywhere across India
- Projects with a profiteering business model are not eligible. However, self-sustaining models that generate revenue solely to fund long-term project viability are permitted
- One organisation may not submit multiple nominations under the same award category. Nominations across different categories from the same organisation are permitted

PART B – NOMINATION PROCESS & GUIDELINES

B1. Submission Rules

- **WORD LIMITS MATTER** – Respect the word limit for each question. Where no limit is stated, keep answers under 500 words. Only the first 500 words will be evaluated.
- **ONE CATEGORY PER FORM** – Each form covers one award category. Submit a separate form for each additional category.

- **MAX 2 NOMINATIONS PER ORGANISATION** – A single organisation may submit for up to 2 different categories only.
- **PLAIN TEXT ONLY** – Do not insert images, tables, or graphics. Do not change the formatting or layout of this form.
- **AI Usage** – Must Not Exceed 30% while filling the nomination form. If detected, the nomination will be rejected
- **** Question **** – Mandatory Question To Be Filled for Evaluation
- **Enclose/Attach** and Submit your official organisation logo (PNG/JPG/JPEG - Up to 1 MB)** to mark your participation in SICA'26 for public display

B2. Supporting Documents

Please underline the documents you will attach. Submit via email – subject line: [Organisation Name] | [Initiative Title] | SICA'26 Nomination. Submit each document in a separate folder with a Google Drive Link (Open To All)

1. Project Brief – Word/PDF (if available) - Max 2 Files
2. Execution Strategy document (if available) - Max 2 Files
3. Audit Statement / Fund Utilisation Report (if available) - Max 2 Files
4. Photographs – max 5 images (if available)
5. Media Coverage – FY 2025–26 (if available) - Max 2 Files
6. Impact Stories / Case Studies – last 2 years (if available) - Max 2 Files
7. Video / Google Drive links (Open to All)– max 2 (if available)
8. External Validation or Certifications (if available) -
9. Any other supporting document - Max 5 Files

File size limit: The total size of documents submitted via email must not exceed 10 MB. Larger files should be shared via Google Drive with open access.

Confidentiality: If any part of your submission contains information you do not wish to share publicly or with third parties, clearly mark it as “CONFIDENTIAL” within the document.

PART C – EVALUATION & JURY PROCESS

C1. Evaluation Process

- All nominations first pass through an editorial scrutiny by TheCSRUniverse Editorial Team before entering the jury round
- Nominations that pass editorial review are evaluated by the Jury Board, which comprises social sector leaders, subject matter experts, policymakers, and academicians
- Jury members evaluate and rate each entry based solely on the nomination form and supporting documents submitted
- All decisions of the Awards Jury – including eligibility of entries, selection of finalists, and selection of winners – are final and binding on all participants
- The organiser reserves the right to disqualify any entry found to contain misrepresented, unverifiable, or fabricated information. The organiser shall not be held liable for any damages arising from such misrepresentation

C2. Benefits of Nomination (Irrespective of Outcome)

- Every eligible nomination that passes editorial scrutiny will be published as a case study or success story on TheCSRUniverse platform, subject to the nominee providing any additional information sought by the editorial team within the required timeframe after the award ceremony
- Each published case study will be promoted once via TheCSRUniverse social media handles and featured in the weekly TheCSRUniverse Newsletter, as per the editorial timeline
- Winning organisations will be invited to attend the SICA'26 event and may be featured in a special e-booklet, on the web platform, and across social media handles
- Project-related articles may be published in case study format on TheCSRUniverse.com and associated media platforms

D1. Event Details

- The award ceremony will be held in person in New Delhi on September 25, 2026. A detailed agenda will be shared with all nominees, winners, partners, and delegates well in advance
- The event format may be changed at the absolute discretion of the organisers. Participants will be notified in advance of any significant changes
- The entire proceedings will be livestreamed via TheCSRUniverse social media handles
- Selected content, stories, projects, and initiatives from among nominations will be published on the TheCSRUniverse web platform

PART E – LEGAL, INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY & GENERAL CONDITIONS

E1. Intellectual Property

- All TheCSRUniverse Social Impact Conference & Awards 2026 intellectual property – including but not limited to trademarks, trade names, logos, designs, promotional materials, web pages, source codes, drawings, illustrations, slogans, and representations – is owned by TCU INFOTECH PRIVATE LIMITED, the owner of TheCSRUniverse Social Impact Conference & Awards and all its past editions
- Unauthorised copying or use of any copyrighted material or intellectual property without express written consent from TCU INFOTECH PRIVATE LIMITED is strictly prohibited
- The organiser reserves the right to post or publish any images or photographs taken at the awards function. Such images and pictures shall become the sole property of the organisers
- Presentation materials, video clips, and photographs shared by nominees may be shown at the event if the entry is judged as a winner or found to be of unique interest

E2. General Conditions

- These Awards are based strictly on the data and supporting documents provided in the nomination form
- The entire award process is conducted online / through the submitted nomination form
- The organiser shall not bear or reimburse any costs incurred by nominees, organisations, individuals, or groups participating in the award distribution ceremony
- The organiser shall not be held responsible, directly or indirectly, for any damages arising from misrepresentation or corroborated facts disclosed by participants
- By participating in the TheCSRUniverse Social Impact Conference & Awards 2026, all participants and entries agree to be bound by these Rules and Regulations, and accept the decisions of the organising committee and the Jury as final
- All decisions of the Awards Jury with respect to any aspect of SICA'26 – including eligibility of entries and selection of winners – are final and binding on all participants
- Participants are encouraged to contact the organising team for any clarifications before submitting their nomination